

HISTORY HACK · DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

Read the following two primary source excerpts and answer the prompt below.

US.37 — Examine challenges and advancements related to the push for civil liberties, including (T.C.A. § 49-6- 1006): • First Red Scare • Immigration Quota Acts of the 1920s • Resurgence of the Ku Klux Klan • Black Wallstreet and Tulsa Massacre • Rise of the NAACP • Efforts of Ida B. Wells-Barnett • Emergence of Garveyism

TEACHER EDITION — scoring guide and expected evidence. Not for student distribution.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

The sources

Document A

Immigration Act of 1924 (Johnson-Reed Act), Section 11, U.S. Statutes at Large, 68th Congress (public domain)

“The annual quota of any nationality shall be two per centum of the number of foreign-born individuals of such nationality resident in continental United States as determined by the United States Census of 1890... The annual quota of any nationality for the fiscal year beginning July 1, 1927, and for each fiscal year thereafter, shall be a number which bears the same ratio to 150,000 as the number of inhabitants in continental United States in 1920 having that national origin bears to the number of inhabitants in continental United States in 1920.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT A

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

Document B

Warren G. Harding, "Return to Normalcy" campaign speech, Boston, Massachusetts, May 14, 1920
(Congressional Record, public domain)

“America's present need is not heroics but healing; not nostrums but normalcy; not revolution but restoration; not agitation but adjustment... not submergence in internationality but sustainment in triumphant nationality.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT B

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

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the audience do or think?

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The question

Using BOTH documents and your knowledge of nativism and immigration policy (US.29) and the political climate of the early 1920s (US.35), write a multi-paragraph response that applies the HIPP framework to each document and constructs an argument about how the ideology of 'Americanism' in the 1920s shaped immigration policy. Your response must analyze both documents' Historical context, Intended audience, Purpose, and Point of view, and explain what the documents reveal when read together.

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document A		
Document B		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

Scoring guide

Pts	6-point scale
6	Exemplary. Full HIPP (all four elements) for both documents. Precise argument about 'Americanism' ideology producing restrictive immigration law. Identifies 1890 census baseline as a deliberate racial mechanism. At least two pieces of outside evidence. Synthesizes both documents into a unified argument.
5	Advanced. HIPP (3+ elements) for both. Clear argument. Both documents used. At least one piece of outside evidence.
4	Proficient. HIPP (2+ elements) for both. Argument present. Both documents used.
3	Adequate. Some HIPP for both documents. Argument present but underdeveloped.
2	Developing. HIPP applied to only one document. Weak argument.
1	Beginning. Summary without HIPP. No clear argument.
0	No response or completely off-topic.

Expected evidence and document analysis. DOCUMENT ANALYSIS EXPECTATIONS: 1890 census baseline as racial mechanism; Harding's 'nationality' as coded exclusion. KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED: Emergency Quota Act 1921, eugenics movement, KKK revival, Asian Exclusion, Madison Grant, Southern/Eastern European targets.

Sourcing. Every document above carries its own citation as written in the item record. Verify each against the holding institution before classroom use — an unsourced primary source is worse than a missing one.

History Hack · TroopToTeacher Technologies. Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28. classroom-formative · pre-field-test — this activity has not been field-tested and its scoring guide is not calibrated.